VTU MBA – MANAGERIAL COMMUNICATION

MODULE 4: BUSINESS REPORTS, PROPOSALS, MEMOS, MEDIA MANAGEMENT, MEETINGS & MEETING DOCUMENTATION

Current VTU scope	What this document does
Business reports; proposals; memos; press release; press conference; media interviews; meetings; meeting planning; notice; agenda; resolution; minutes.	Explains concepts, shows formats, gives worked examples, diagrams, cases, exam questions and answer frameworks.

EXAM FOCUS Current VTU MBA106 allocates 9 hours to Module 4. The current syllabus wording is reproduced in the next section. Historical question-paper evidence is clearly labelled and is not treated as a prediction of future questions.

1. Syllabus Alignment & Truth-Mode Guide

Current official VTU 2024–25 syllabus, MBA106, Module 4 (9 hours):

Syllabus area	Coverage in these notes
Business Reports	Purpose; kinds/objectives; organization & preparation; short and long reports.
Writing Proposals	Structure and preparation.
Writing Memos	Purpose, structure, examples and drafting.
Media Management	Press release; press conference; media interviews.
Group Communication	Meetings; planning; objectives; participants; timing; venue.
Meeting Documentation	Notice; agenda; resolution; minutes.

Truth mode:

- VTU syllabus and exam-pattern statements are source-grounded in the current official VTU material.
- Report concepts and structures are primarily grounded in P. D. Chaturvedi & Mukesh Chaturvedi, especially Chapter 13; memo material is grounded in Chapter 11.
- Meeting-planning and agenda practices are supplemented by Guffey, Business Communication: Process & Product.
- Examples, sample data, case studies, diagrams and exam-style questions created specifically for these notes are teaching constructions unless explicitly labelled as historical VTU questions.
- Historical questions demonstrate what VTU has asked before; they do not guarantee what VTU will ask next.

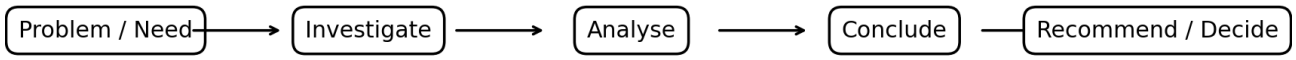
Source integrity note: the current syllabus does NOT list business-case analysis in Module 4, so it is not taught as a Module 4 topic here even though older VTU schemes placed it there.

2. The Managerial Communication Toolkit

The fastest way to understand Module 4 is to connect each communication artifact to the managerial outcome it is designed to achieve.

Need	Best-fit communication artifact	Primary audience	Desired outcome
Investigate a problem and recommend action	Report	Management / decision makers	Decision based on evidence
Seek approval, funding or support	Proposal	Sponsor / management / client	Approval / commitment
Give internal information or instruction	Memo	Employees / departments	Understanding / action
Create public news	Press release	Media / public	Accurate public information
Handle media interaction	Press conference / interview	Journalists / public	Clear, credible answers
Discuss and decide	Meeting	Relevant stakeholders	Decision / alignment
Create official record	Notice / agenda / resolution / minutes	Members / organization	Traceability / action

Business Report Logic



A report should help the reader understand a situation and decide what to do.

EXAM FOCUS High-value distinction: a report primarily investigates/analyzes and may recommend; a proposal primarily seeks approval or action. A memo communicates internally. Minutes record proceedings and decisions.

3. Business Reports

3.1 Meaning of a Business Report

A business report is an assigned communication prepared for a specific purpose and reader, normally based on investigation, evidence and analysis. Chaturvedi emphasizes that a report should help management understand a situation, identify causes and alternatives, and reach specific conclusions about the problem and its solution.

A report is therefore not simply a long description of facts.

Weak report	Better report
Sales fell by 12%. Customers complained. Staff were unhappy.	Sales fell 12%; the evidence was analyzed by product, region and channel; three causes were identified; two alternatives were evaluated; a recommendation is made.
The project may be delayed.	The project is forecast to slip by 18 days because of supplier and testing constraints; the report compares recovery options and recommends a revised plan.

3.2 Purposes / Objectives of Reports

- Inform management about a situation, activity, project or problem.
- Present investigated facts and evidence.
- Analyze causes, implications and alternatives.
- Support managerial decision-making.
- Present conclusions derived from evidence.
- Recommend a course of action where the assignment requires it.
- Create a formal record of findings, progress or compliance.

3.3 Kinds of Reports

Type	Meaning / use	Example
Routine report	Regularly prepared using a standard process or form.	Daily production report.
Letter report	Report presented in letter form, often for a smaller issue or external reader.	Report to a client on a service issue.
Memo report	Short internal report in memo form.	Internal status report.
Progress report	Shows progress/status against a plan.	ERP implementation progress.
Periodic report	Prepared at regular intervals.	Monthly sales report.
Laboratory / technical report	Reports results of technical or laboratory work.	Quality test report.
Short report	Compact report with a simpler structure.	One-page management recommendation.
Formal / long report	Detailed, structured and documented report.	Feasibility study for a new facility.

3.4 Report vs Essay

Report	Essay
Purpose is usually organizational / managerial.	Often explores a topic or argument.
Evidence and investigation are central.	May be more subjective or argumentative.
Structured with headings/subheadings.	May use continuous prose.
Findings, conclusions and recommendations may be explicit.	Conclusion may not contain a managerial recommendation.
Tables/figures may be used to compress information.	Visuals are not normally a defining feature.

3.5 Terms of Reference

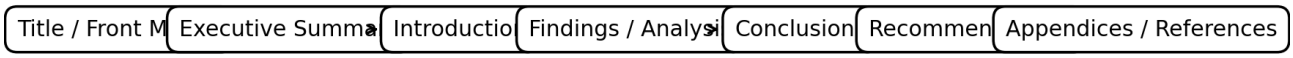
When an organization assigns a report, the authorized boundaries of the task are the terms of reference. Chaturvedi identifies elements such as the problem, purpose, scope, limitations, budget/resources, relevant organizational considerations and submission deadline.

Element	Question the writer asks
Problem	What situation must be investigated?
Purpose	Why is the report required?
Scope	What is included and excluded?
Limitations	What constraints affect the investigation?
Resources / budget	What evidence, people or resources are available?
Deadline	When must the report be submitted?

3.6 Planning and Organizing a Report

1. Clarify the assignment and terms of reference.
2. Identify the audience and decisions the reader may need to make.
3. Define the information needed.
4. Collect reliable evidence: records, observations, interviews, surveys or other appropriate sources.
5. Analyze rather than merely describe the evidence.
6. Group related information and establish a logical sequence.
7. Create an outline before drafting.
8. Write findings, conclusions and recommendations so that each is supported by evidence.
9. Revise for accuracy, clarity, conciseness and reader usefulness.

Long Formal Report — Typical Structure



Exact ordering varies by organization and assignment; follow the prescribed format when one exists.

3.7 Structure of a Short Report

- Heading / title or memo heading.
- Purpose / issue.
- Brief background or scope.
- Findings / evidence.
- Analysis.
- Conclusion.
- Recommendation(s), if required.
- Attachments or supporting data when needed.

Worked Example: Short Management Report

Situation: A college canteen has received 86 complaints about waiting time in one month. Average lunch-hour waiting time is 18 minutes. The principal asks for a short report recommending an improvement.

Section	Sample content
Purpose	To identify the main causes of lunch-hour delays and recommend a practical intervention.
Evidence	Observation shows 62% of delay occurs at billing; two of four counters are often idle because of manual reconciliation.
Analysis	Adding staff alone may not solve the bottleneck. Digital pre-ordering and faster payment reconciliation address the identified constraint.
Conclusion	Billing and reconciliation are the primary bottlenecks.
Recommendation	Pilot QR/pre-order billing for four weeks during 12:30–1:30 p.m.; review waiting time weekly.

EXAM FOCUS For a 10-mark report-writing question, do not spend most of the answer defining reports. Show the report format and write usable content under clear headings. Evidence → analysis → conclusion → recommendation earns more value than descriptive prose.

4. Short and Long Reports

4.1 Short vs Long Reports

Feature	Short report	Long formal report
Length	Compact; only necessary detail.	Detailed; extensive evidence and documentation.
Front matter	Minimal.	May include title page, transmittal material and contents.
Main body	Often begins directly with purpose/findings.	Structured into introduction, discussion/analysis, conclusions and recommendations.
Supporting material	Limited.	Appendices, references, glossary, tables/figures may be used.
Reader need	Quick managerial use.	Complex decision, record, study or formal submission.
Typical format	Memo/letter/brief report.	Fully structured formal report.

4.2 Long Formal Report — Practical Structure

- Title page.
- Letter of transmittal / cover material when required.
- Table of contents for substantial reports.
- Executive summary / abstract.
- Introduction: background, purpose, scope and method.
- Discussion / findings / analysis.
- Conclusions.
- Recommendations.
- References / bibliography where applicable.
- Glossary when specialized terminology requires it.
- Appendices for supporting data, instruments, detailed tables or documents.

4.3 Executive Summary

An executive summary is a concise, decision-oriented version of a longer report. It should allow a busy manager to understand the issue, approach, key findings, conclusions and recommendations without reading the entire report.

Include	Do not turn it into
Problem / purpose	A generic introduction.
Scope / method in brief	A detailed methodology chapter.
Most important findings	A data dump.
Conclusion	A new argument not found in the report.
Recommendations / implications	Marketing-style praise.

Exam-ready executive summary example

Objective: assess whether the institute should introduce a digital attendance system. Findings: manual attendance consumes approximately 9 minutes per class and produces frequent reconciliation errors. A three-week pilot of QR-based attendance reduced recording time to about 2 minutes per class in the sample tested. Recommendation: conduct a controlled pilot across two sections for one semester, with privacy controls and a manual fallback. Review accuracy, faculty time and student acceptance before wider adoption.

5. Writing Proposals

A proposal is a planned request for approval, support, funding, permission or acceptance of a proposed course of action. It differs from a report mainly in its immediate purpose: a report may investigate and recommend; a proposal is designed to persuade an authorized reader to approve a plan.

Proposal Logic



5.1 When is a Proposal Appropriate?

- Requesting approval for a project.
- Requesting budget or resources.
- Proposing a training programme.
- Responding to a client's request for proposal (RFP).
- Seeking permission to conduct a study or pilot.
- Proposing a process improvement.

5.2 Practical Proposal Structure

Section	What it answers
Title	What is being proposed?
Background / problem	Why is the proposal needed?
Objective	What measurable outcome is sought?
Proposed solution / methodology	What exactly will be done?
Scope / deliverables	What will be included?
Schedule	When will it happen?
Resources / budget	What will it cost and what is needed?
Benefits / value	Why should the reader approve it?
Risks / assumptions	What could affect success?
Evaluation	How will success be measured?
Request / closing	What approval or action is required?

Worked Proposal Example

Proposal: One-Semester Business Analytics Skill Programme for MBA Students

- Problem: students understand basic concepts but have limited evidence of applied analytics skills.

- Objective: train 60 students through 10 practical missions covering Excel, visualization, business interpretation and AI-assisted analytics.
- Method: two sessions per week; each mission ends with an assessed artifact.
- Resources: existing computer lab, faculty mentors and low-cost/open tools.
- Schedule: 12 weeks.
- Budget: ₹75,000 for consumables, external workshops and contingency.
- Success measures: attendance, completion rate, practical assessment scores and portfolio artifacts.
- Decision requested: approval to run the pilot for one semester.

Proposal vs Report

Report	Proposal
Looks backward/current: what happened, what evidence shows, what it means.	Looks forward: what should be done and why.
May be neutral or evaluative.	Usually persuasive.
Recommendation may be one outcome.	Approval/action is normally the immediate objective.

EXAM FOCUS If asked to 'write a proposal', use headings. A 10-mark answer should look like a real proposal, not an essay about proposals.

6. Writing Memos

A memorandum (memo) is an internal business message used to communicate information, instructions, policy decisions, suggestions or records of agreements. Chaturvedi notes that a memo can act as a permanent record of what was communicated; therefore, vague wording is dangerous.

6.1 Functions of a Memo

Function	Example
Provide information	Summary of an executive committee meeting.
Issue an instruction	All department heads must submit the monthly forecast by 4 p.m. Friday.
Convey a policy decision	The organization will move to a new travel-approval process.
Offer suggestions	Recommend a monthly safety review.
Record an agreement / decision	The team agreed to pilot the new process for four weeks.

6.2 Memo Format

Field	Sample
TO	All Department Heads
FROM	Mahesh V. Shet, Director – Administration
DATE	7 October 2026
SUBJECT	Monthly Review Meeting – Data Submission Deadline
Purpose / opening	This memo confirms the information required for the monthly review.
Action	Submit the completed template to the shared folder by 4:00 p.m. on Friday, 9 October.
Details	Include actuals, variance, explanation and corrective action.
Close	Please contact the administration office if clarification is required.

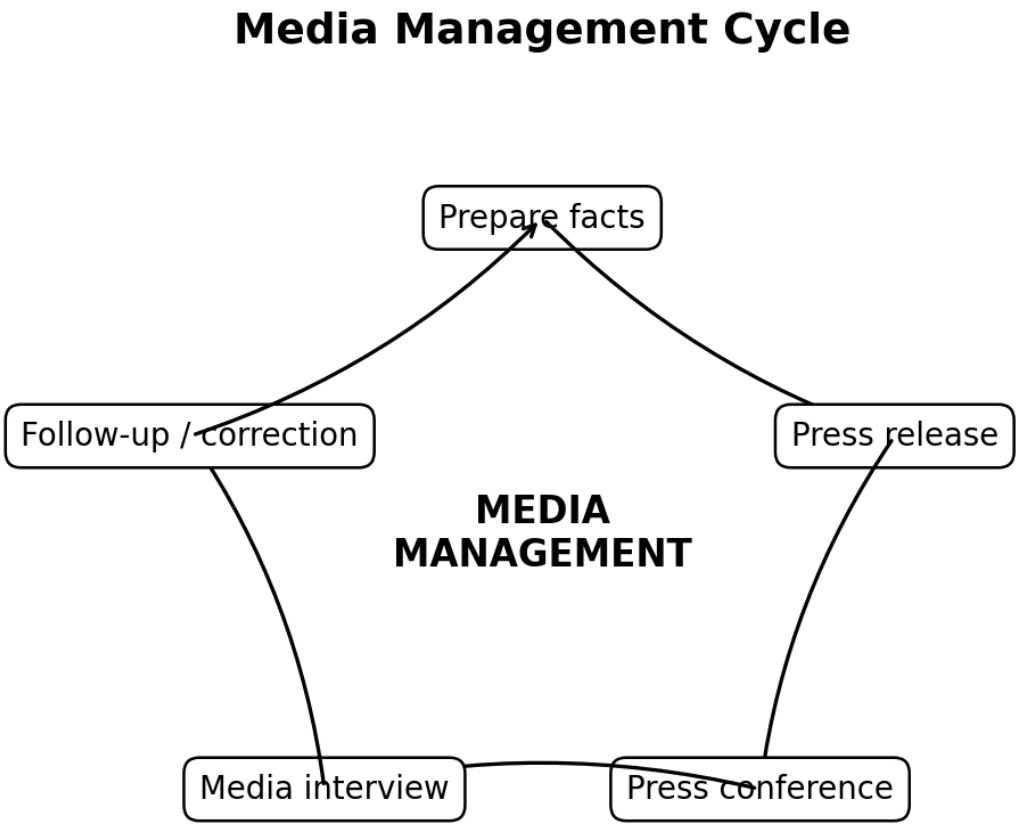
6.3 Bad Memo → Better Memo

Weak	Better
Send the reports soon.	Send the September reports to Finance by 4:00 p.m. on 9 October.
Meet Saturday morning.	All supervisors will meet in Conference Room 2 at 10:00 a.m. on Saturday, 10 October.
Clean up the area.	Remove unused material, label active files and clear the aisle before the safety inspection.

EXAM FOCUS The examiner can easily test 'Define memo and mention components' or 'Draft a memo'. Memorize the four core fields—TO, FROM, DATE, SUBJECT—and then write a clear purpose/action body.

7. Media Management

Media management in managerial communication concerns how an organization communicates news and responds to journalists. The syllabus specifically requires press releases, press conferences and media interviews.



7.1 Press Release

A press release is a written news-oriented communication issued by an organization to provide journalists with factual information about a newsworthy development. It is not simply an advertisement.

Typical element	Purpose
Organization / release label	Identifies the source.
Headline	States the news clearly and briefly.
Dateline	Gives location and date where appropriate.
Lead	Answers the most important part of who/what/when/where/why/how.
Body	Provides supporting facts and context.
Quote	Adds a human/managerial voice; must be accurate and attributable.

Boilerplate	Brief description of the organization, where used.
Media contact	Provides a way to obtain further information.

7.2 Worked Press Release

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

JNNCE Launches Student Analytics Challenge to Build Industry-Ready Skills

Shivamogga, 7 October 2026 — The Department of Management at JNNCE has launched a semester-long Student Analytics Challenge designed to help MBA students apply business analytics to practical problems. The programme will combine short missions, team problem-solving and assessed deliverables. Faculty members and industry practitioners will mentor selected teams. The first challenge will focus on using business data to identify and explain a measurable operational problem. 'The objective is not to teach another software package; it is to help students turn data into a business decision,' said the programme coordinator. Further details on participation and schedules will be released by the Department of Management.

Media contact: Department of Management, JNNCE, Shivamogga.

Why this works: it has a clear news angle, avoids unsupported superlatives, gives specific facts and uses a quote that adds information rather than empty praise.

7.3 Press Conference

A press conference is a planned media interaction in which an organization makes an announcement or provides information and then responds to questions from journalists.

10. Define the news and objective.
11. Select a credible spokesperson.
12. Prepare verified facts, key messages and likely difficult questions.
13. Prepare venue/technology, media invitation and press materials.
14. Open with a concise statement.
15. Take questions systematically; answer only what is known and relevant.
16. Correct factual errors promptly rather than speculating.
17. Provide follow-up contact information and materials.

7.4 Media Interview

A media interview is a direct interaction between a spokesperson/source and a journalist. It may be live or recorded and can be conducted in person, by phone or through other media.

Before	During	After
Research the topic and journalist/context.	Answer the question asked first.	Check whether factual clarification is needed.
Prepare 3–5 key messages.	Use short, clear sentences.	Provide promised facts promptly.
Identify facts that cannot be disclosed and why.	Do not speculate; say what is known and what is not known.	Correct material factual errors promptly.

Prepare likely difficult questions.	Ask for clarification if a question is unclear.	Record what was agreed for follow-up.

Current practical note: good interviewing/reporting practice emphasizes preparation, open-ended questions, listening and follow-up; journalists also need accuracy and clear attribution. These principles matter to managers because a spokesperson should never invent facts to fill a silence.
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EXAM FOCUS A press release is written communication; a press conference is a live media event; a media interview is an interview interaction. Do not write them as if they are the same.

8. Group Communication: Meetings

A meeting is a planned interaction among two or more people for a defined organizational purpose. A useful managerial meeting should move toward information sharing, problem-solving, decision-making, coordination or another explicit outcome.

8.1 Common Objectives of Meetings

- Share information that requires interaction or clarification.
- Discuss and solve a problem.
- Make a decision.
- Coordinate activities across people or departments.
- Generate alternatives or ideas.
- Review progress and corrective action.
- Assign responsibilities and deadlines.

Effective Meeting Planning → Decision → Action



8.2 Planning a Meeting: Five Questions

Five Planning Questions for a Meeting



Why = objective | Who = participants | When = timing | Where = venue | What = agenda / decisions

Question	Decision
Why?	What outcome must exist when the meeting ends?
Who?	Who has authority, information, implementation responsibility or a legitimate affected-group perspective?
When?	Date, start/end time and duration.
Where?	Physical room or online platform; accessibility/technology needs.

What?	Agenda items, pre-reading, decisions required and expected preparation.

8.3 Selecting Participants

- Decision makers or people with the authority required.
- People with necessary information/expertise.
- People responsible for implementation.
- Representatives of affected groups when their input materially changes the decision.
- Avoid inviting people merely 'for information' if they add no decision value.

Guffey's practical guidance recommends keeping many operational meetings small enough to remain productive and ensuring that decision makers, information holders and implementers are represented. It also recommends distributing the agenda and relevant materials in advance. 毅filecite孳turn60file4傣

8.4 Timing and Venue

Factor	Good practice
Timing	Choose a time that supports attendance and allows the required preparation; specify start and end times.
Duration	Allocate time by agenda item rather than allowing discussion to expand without control.
Venue	Choose a room/platform appropriate to the meeting's size, privacy, technology and purpose.
Online meetings	Test access, audio/video and documents; establish participation rules.

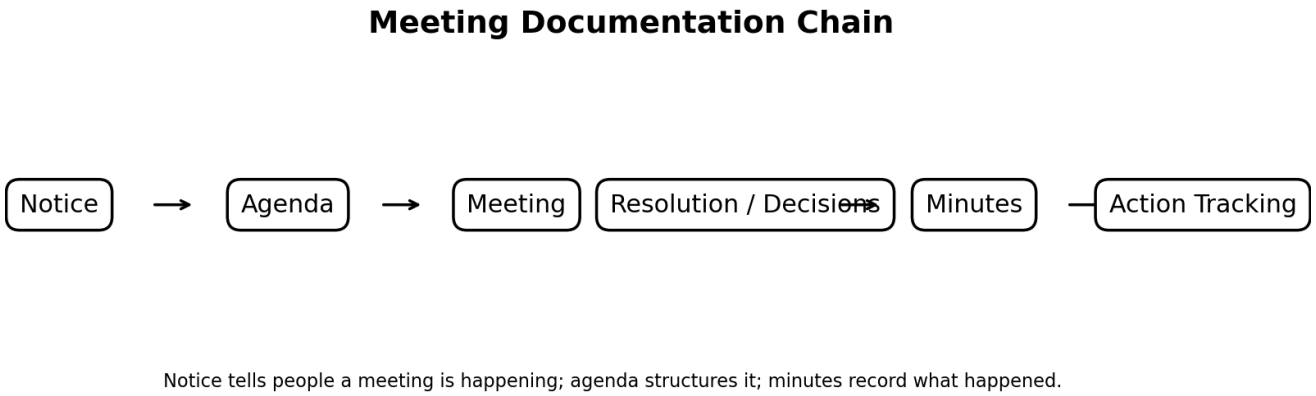
8.5 Role of the Chairperson

- Start on time and state the objective.
- Keep discussion linked to the agenda.
- Ensure participants are heard without allowing one person to monopolize.
- Separate facts, opinions and decisions.
- Handle disagreement without allowing personal attacks.
- Summarize emerging agreements.
- Confirm the final decision and action owners before closing.

Chaturvedi emphasizes the agenda as a control mechanism and the chairperson's role in keeping discussion sequential, relevant and solution-oriented. 毅filecite孳turn60file2傣

9. Meeting Documentation

The four high-value documents form a chain:



9.1 Notice

A notice announces a meeting and gives the information needed for members to attend.

Notice field	Example
Organization	ABC Student Association
Title	NOTICE OF MEETING
Date of notice	7 October 2026
Meeting date/time	12 October 2026, 2:00–3:00 p.m.
Venue	Seminar Hall 2
Purpose	To discuss and decide the Management Fest plan.
Authority / issuer	Secretary, ABC Student Association

9.2 Agenda

An agenda is the ordered plan of business for a meeting. It helps participants prepare, keeps discussion focused and provides a time structure.

Item	Agenda example	Time
1	Call to order / attendance	2 min
2	Confirmation of previous minutes	5 min
3	Management Fest budget proposal	15 min
4	Event responsibilities	15 min
5	Risk / contingency planning	8 min
6	Other business with chair's permission	3 min
7	Summary, action owners and adjournment	2 min

A strong agenda usually contains date/place, start/end time, ordered topics, responsible persons and time allocations. Guffey recommends distributing the agenda and relevant pre-reading in advance.
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9.3 Resolution

A resolution is a formal statement of a decision adopted by the authorized body. It should be specific enough to show what was approved, by whom/under what authority, and any important implementation condition.

Example: “RESOLVED THAT the Student Council approves a budget of ₹1,20,000 for the Management Fest 2026, subject to submission of vendor quotations and approval by the faculty coordinator.”

Resolution vs Minutes

Resolution	Minutes
Formal decision.	Official record of the proceedings.
Focused on what was decided.	Records relevant discussion, decisions, actions and other proceedings.
May be extracted as a specific decision.	Usually contains the broader meeting record.
Must be precise and authorized.	Must be accurate and neutral.

9.4 Minutes

Minutes are the formal record of a meeting. They should record what matters for organizational accountability: attendance, agenda/business considered, key decisions, resolutions, action items and other required formalities. They should not normally become a word-for-word transcript.

Minutes section	Sample
Meeting	Student Council Meeting – Management Fest 2026
Date/time/venue	12 Oct 2026, 2:00 p.m., Seminar Hall 2
Members present	Chairperson + listed members
Agenda item	Budget proposal
Decision	Budget of ₹1,20,000 approved subject to quotations.
Action	Treasurer to obtain three quotations by 16 Oct.
Next meeting	19 Oct 2026, 2:00 p.m.
Authentication	Secretary / Chairperson as required

Notice → Agenda → Meeting → Minutes: Worked Example

Scenario: A department must decide whether to pilot a student analytics challenge.

18. Notice: announce the meeting for 10 October at 2:00 p.m.
19. Agenda: include pilot objective, participant capacity, budget, assessment and approval.
20. Meeting: discuss evidence and options.
21. Resolution: approve a 12-week pilot for 60 students with a defined budget and review point.

22. Minutes: record the decision, dissent if formally relevant, action owners and deadlines.

EXAM FOCUS A common high-scoring answer is to distinguish the four documents: Notice = announcement; Agenda = plan; Resolution = formal decision; Minutes = record.

10. Integrated Case Studies

Case 1 — The 12% Project Delay

Case: A college ERP implementation is 12% behind schedule. The project manager has data showing delays in vendor configuration and user acceptance testing. The principal wants a decision on whether to add temporary resources or extend the deadline.

Suggested answer logic:

- Use a short management report.
- Include purpose, scope, evidence/findings, analysis, conclusion and recommendation.
- Do not recommend from the delay percentage alone; identify causes, remaining work, cost, risk and alternative recovery options.
- Recommendation should be specific, evidence-based and implementable.

Case 2 — Proposal for a Student Analytics Pilot

Case: An MBA department wants approval for a 12-week analytics programme for 60 students using existing infrastructure. The sponsor asks for a proposal.

Suggested answer logic:

- Problem → objective → solution → resources/budget → schedule → benefits → risks → evaluation → approval request.
- Use measurable outcomes, not vague claims such as 'students will become excellent'.
- Risks might include attendance, faculty capacity and uneven student skill levels.

Case 3 — Product Recall and Media Pressure

Case: A consumer product has a confirmed quality issue. Journalists ask whether the organization knew about the problem earlier. The facts are still being verified.

Suggested answer logic:

- State what is confirmed and what is still under verification.
- Do not invent a date, cause or number.
- A press conference may be appropriate when the issue is significant and a coordinated public response is needed; the decision depends on the circumstances.
- Avoid speculation, blaming individuals without evidence and misleading reassurance.

Case 4 — Meeting That Produces No Decision

Case: A 14-person committee meets for two hours. There is no agenda. Three people dominate the discussion. Several topics are introduced without decision authority. The meeting ends with 'we will discuss this again next week.'

Suggested answer logic:

- No explicit objective; wrong/too many participants; no time structure; no agenda; no decision authority; poor chair control.
- Invite people who can decide, inform and implement.
- Put decisions in the agenda and assign time.
- Summarize decisions and action owners before closing.

Case 5 — Documentation Error

Case: The secretary's minutes say: 'Everyone agreed to increase the event budget significantly.' The actual decision was to approve ₹1,20,000 subject to three vendor quotations.

Suggested answer logic:

- The wording is vague and overstates agreement.
- Record the exact approved amount and condition.
- Use agenda papers, note decisions during the meeting, confirm wording before closure and circulate minutes for review according to organizational practice.

11. VTU Examination Questions — Historical Evidence + Practice

The following distinction is important: the questions explicitly labelled 'Historical VTU evidence' are drawn from older VTU papers/model material located during research. The practice questions are newly constructed from the current syllabus. Neither set is a prediction.

11.1 Historical VTU Evidence

Question / evidence	Source status
2021 official VTU model paper: “What is an Agenda?” (3 marks).	Official VTU model paper for 20MBA16. 毅cite孳turn0search12傢
2021 official VTU model paper: “Discuss the common reasons for holding of the meetings.” (7 marks).	Official VTU model paper. 毅cite孳turn0search12傢
2021 official VTU model paper: “Draft a memo … regarding ban on cigarette smoking.” (10 marks).	Official VTU model paper. 毅cite孳turn0search12傢
July/Aug 2022 paper: “What is Resolution?” (3 marks); draft Notice + Agenda + Minutes for a Management Fest (10 marks).	Indexed copy of historical paper; not current official syllabus evidence. 毅cite孳turn1search3傢
Jan/Feb 2021 paper: “What do you mean by Report writing?” (3); objectives of report (7); types of business reports (10).	Indexed historical paper; not treated as official current prediction. 毅cite孳turn1search3傢
Older VTU questions included press release elements, press conferences, media interviews, agenda, notice and minutes.	Historical question compilation; useful only as evidence of recurring topic types. 毅cite孳turn1search1傢

12. 10-Mark Drafting Templates

12.1 Short Report Template

TITLE: [Specific report title]

TO: [Decision maker]

FROM: [Writer]

DATE: [Date]

PURPOSE: [One sentence]

BACKGROUND/SCOPE: [Relevant context]

FINDINGS: [Evidence]

ANALYSIS: [What the evidence means]

CONCLUSION: [What follows]

RECOMMENDATION: [Specific action, owner/time if appropriate]

12.2 Proposal Template

TITLE

1. Background / problem

2. Objective(s)
3. Proposed solution / methodology
4. Scope and deliverables
5. Schedule
6. Resources / budget
7. Benefits / value
8. Risks / assumptions
9. Evaluation / success measures
10. Approval requested

12.3 Memo Template

MEMORANDUM
TO:
FROM:
DATE:
SUBJECT:
Purpose/opening
Required action
Details / supporting information
Deadline / responsibility
Closing

12.4 Press Release Template

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE
HEADLINE
Sub-headline (optional)
CITY, DATE — Lead paragraph with the news.
Supporting facts/context.
Quote from authorized spokesperson.
Additional relevant detail.
Organization boilerplate.
Media contact.

12.5 Notice Template

NAME OF ORGANIZATION
NOTICE OF MEETING
Date of notice:
Date/time of meeting:
Venue/platform:
Purpose:

Members/participants:

Issued by: [Secretary/authorized officer]

12.6 Agenda Template

NAME OF ORGANIZATION

AGENDA

Meeting/date/time/venue

1. Call to order
2. Confirmation of previous minutes
3. Item 1 — [time / responsible person]
4. Item 2 — [time / responsible person]
5. Other business with chair's permission
6. Decisions/action owners
7. Adjournment

12.7 Minutes Template

NAME OF ORGANIZATION

MINUTES OF MEETING

Date/time/venue

Chairperson

Members present / absent

1. Confirmation of previous minutes
2. Agenda item 1 — key discussion and decision
3. Agenda item 2 — key discussion and decision

RESOLUTIONS ADOPTED

ACTION ITEMS: action / owner / deadline

Next meeting

Prepared by: [Secretary]

Approved by: [Chairperson, where required]

14. One-Page Revision Sheet

Topic	Remember this
Report	Investigate → Analyse → Conclude → Recommend
Report purpose	Help management understand a situation and support action/decision.
Kinds	Routine, letter, memo, progress, periodic, laboratory/technical, short, formal.
Terms of reference	Problem, purpose, scope, limitations, resources/budget, deadline.
Short report	Compact, direct, minimal front/back matter.
Long report	Structured, detailed, may include executive summary, contents, references, appendices.
Proposal	Problem → Solution → Feasibility → Cost → Approval.
Memo	TO → FROM → DATE → SUBJECT → clear action/details.
Press release	Headline → Dateline → Lead → Body → Quote → Boilerplate → Contact.
Press conference	Planned media event + opening statement + questions.
Media interview	Prepare → answer accurately → don't speculate → follow up.
Meeting	WHY → WHO → WHEN → WHERE → WHAT.
Notice	Announces meeting.
Agenda	Structures meeting.
Resolution	States formal decision.
Minutes	Records proceedings/decisions/actions.

Final mental model

If you remember only this: REPORT = understand the problem; PROPOSAL = approve the plan; MEMO = communicate internally; MEDIA = communicate publicly and answer questions; MEETING = discuss and decide; DOCUMENTATION = preserve the decision and action trail.

15. Sources & Source Integrity

Primary / supplied sources used:

- Visvesvaraya Technological University, MBA106 Managerial Communication, 2024–25 syllabus (current syllabus).
- P. D. Chaturvedi & Mukesh Chaturvedi, Business Communication: Skills, Concepts, Cases & Applications, especially Chapter 13 (Business Reports) and Chapter 11 (Business Letters, Memos and E-mails).
- Mary Ellen Guffey, Dana Loewy & Esther Griffin, Business Communication: Process & Product, especially meeting planning and agenda guidance.
- Previously created Module 4 teaching deck based on the same current syllabus and supplied books.

Web-researched historical/model-paper evidence:

- VTU official 20MBA16 model question paper (2021): agenda, meetings and memo drafting examples. 毅cite孳turn0search12傣
- Historical indexed question-paper evidence for resolution, notice, agenda and minutes; used only to identify recurring assessment forms, not to predict future papers. 毅cite孳turn1search3孳turn1search1傣
- Current official VTU 2024–25 syllabus confirms the exact Module 4 topic list and 9-hour allocation. 毅cite孳turn1search23傣
- Poynter interviewing guidance used only for practical media-interview principles such as preparation, open questions, listening and follow-up. 毅cite孳turn2search2孳turn2search6傣

Important: examples, cases, sample organizations, amounts, dates and diagrams in this document are instructional constructions unless a source is explicitly identified. They are not presented as real events.

End of Module 4 Study Notes